

1. Importance of Session:

Sessions are crucial for maintaining user-specific state across multiple HTTP requests, since HTTP is stateless. They enable features like login persistence, shopping carts, and user preferences without requiring users to re-authenticate for every action. For example, when you add items to an Amazon cart and continue browsing, the session ID keeps your cart tied to you. Sessions also enhance security by storing sensitive data (e.g., user ID, role) on the server, away from client tampering. Without sessions, every page load would treat you as a new, anonymous visitor.

2. Session vs. Cookies:

Session	Cookies
Data stored on the server (e.g., in memory, database, or file system).	Data stored on the client (browser) as small text files.
Temporary – expires when the browser closes or after a server-set timeout (e.g., 30 mins).	Persistent – can last for days/years if an expiry date is set (e.g., "Remember Me" token).

Secure – sensitive info (e.g., user ID, roles) stays server- side; only a session ID is sent to client.	Less secure – data is visible and editable by the user; never store password s or payment info.
Capacity – can store large/com plex data (arrays, objects) on the server.	Size limit – max ~4KB per cookie, only string data.
Example – Storing <code>logged_in</code> <code>_user_id</code> <code>= 101</code> on the server after login.	Example – Storing <code>theme =</code> <code>dark</code> or <code>language =</code> <code>en</code> in the browser

	for UI preferenc es.
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